

THE WORLD ACCORDING TO GOOGLE

“GenNext will consume information on demand”

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The Google philosophy is making sure that employees are happy, have the ability to be intellectually stimulated and contribute. There is no hierarchy in the company. What contributes to our success is the ability to take the best opinion in the organisation and have it represented. The first Darwinian principal of product development at Google is to launch early otherwise the world will pass you by. And so it is important to understand failing is okay. A lot of the successes including Google, YouTube and Facebook weren't designed to do what they do today. Google was a research project by two guys at Stanford who were actually trying to digitise the library and it became a search engine for a few billion people around the world. We always try and get people to design products, and if they

don't work, we launch them.

I was flying with our founder over the US once and he said that the mapping industry had old maps with pictures taken by high-orbiting satellites. A day later, we figured out how many planes could cover the US with 75 cm resolution. At business school, they teach you the 4 Ps—the product, the price, the promotion, the placement. We actually eliminated the three Ps and focus only on building a great product. Everything else will work out. If you build a crappy product, you have to worry about the three Ps. The idea of flying planes over the US allowed us to map all of Haiti within one week and help find people in rubble. Very seldom does a conversation in Google start about making money. Hence, many of our products are free and we are still trying to figure out how we are going to make money out of it.

There are over a billion or more people over the globe connected to the Internet. People's behaviour is changing with greater Internet access. We are turning into an information-on-demand society. We expect answers right way. When we launched Google news, we crawled all the news sites every 24 hours. Now we crawl all the news sites every 15 minutes. All this requires tremendous amounts of computing power. Google is the only website where we are trying to get people away from our website as quickly as possible. To do that we have to spend even more money trying to put out more data centres to satisfy this need of more and more consumers seeking instant gratification. Future generations are going to consume information more on demand.

Another societal trend is exhibitionism. I am surprised at how many personal things people are willing to share on Facebook and Twitter. Every business is trying to get consumers to visit their websites and spend a lot of time. That turns into advertising and the ability to sell products. Content is always going to be the centre of everything. The social networking business has figured out how to get 100 million and 400 million people to log in three to five times a day. People in India spend an average two-and-a-half hours on social media a day. That's phenomenal. I don't know how that translates to what's going to happen, but, I think over time what's going to happen is this community-centric approach of consumerists will actually reverse and bring content into it as opposed to content being a centre of this community. It's

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